

# Brand Identity Checklist

Everything your visual identity needs to be complete, consistent, and ready to hand to any designer or printer.

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## WHO THIS IS FOR

Business owners who've had a logo made and assumed that was the identity — and are now discovering how many other pieces are actually needed to look consistent everywhere the brand shows up.

## HOW TO USE IT

Use this before you consider your identity "done," and again before you hand your brand assets to a new designer, printer, or agency partner. Anything left unchecked is a gap someone will eventually have to fill under time pressure.

## 1. CORE MARK

- [ ] Primary logo exists as vector artwork (AI, EPS, or SVG) — not just a PNG exported from someone's phone.
- [ ] A one-color (black) and reversed (white) version of the logo exist for dark or busy backgrounds.
- [ ] A simplified mark or icon-only version exists for small spaces.  
*Favicons, social profile photos, app icons, embroidery.*
- [ ] Minimum size and clear-space rules are documented, so the logo doesn't get shrunk until it's illegible.
- [ ] There's a written list of what NOT to do to the logo — stretching, recoloring, adding effects.

## 2. COLOR

- [ ] Primary and secondary brand colors are documented with exact HEX, RGB, and CMYK values.
- [ ] A print-safe Pantone reference exists for each core color, if the brand will ever be printed.  
*Screen color and print color are not the same thing — this prevents a shock at the print shop.*
- [ ] There's a documented rule for how much of each color to use — which one dominates, which are accents.
- [ ] Colors have been checked for accessible contrast against both white and black backgrounds.

## 3. TYPOGRAPHY

- [ ] A primary typeface is chosen for headlines, and a secondary typeface for body text.
- [ ] Font files or licenses are saved somewhere the business actually owns, not just on one designer's laptop.

- [ ] A free, similar substitute font is documented for use in tools that can't load the brand fonts.

*Google Docs, PowerPoint, WhatsApp Business catalogs, and similar.*

## 4. SUPPORTING SYSTEM

- [ ] A short pattern, texture, or graphic device exists beyond the logo.

*Something that makes materials recognizable even without the logo visible.*

- [ ] Photography or imagery style is defined — mood, color treatment, what's in frame and what isn't.

- [ ] Icon style is defined, if the brand uses icons anywhere (app, website, signage).

## 5. APPLIED & DOCUMENTED

- [ ] All of the above lives in one brand guideline document — not scattered across old emails and chat exports.

- [ ] The identity has been test-applied to at least 3 real materials.

*Business card, social post template, and one large-format piece (banner, signage, packaging).*

- [ ] Someone outside the business could open the guideline document and apply the brand correctly without asking a follow-up question.

### REALITY CHECK

If your "brand identity" is currently one AI file on a designer's laptop and a WhatsApp export of the logo, you don't have a usable identity yet — you have a logo. The gap between the two is exactly what this checklist closes.

## NEXT STEPS

**A complete identity system doesn't need to be expensive or built all at once — but it does need to exist somewhere durable and shareable before you scale marketing spend, open a second location, or bring on a partner. Once this list is fully checked, you have a real brand asset, not just a logo file.**